// CLAUDE DESIGN EDITION

5 prompts. Your brand. On canvas.

The Claude Design versions of the workshop prompts. Run them in the chat panel at claude.ai/design after you've uploaded your DESIGN.md as the project's design system.

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01 **The Master Check** — confirm DESIGN.md is loaded, set the rules.

02 **Topic to Carousel** — 7 slides rendered on canvas.

03 **Winning Ad to My Version** — forensic decode + 3 variations.

04 **Pinterest to My Layout** — borrow structure, never colors.

05 **Iterate to Refine** — V1 + V2 side by side.

Daniel Paul
Founder, Purely Personal
claude-design-beginners.vercel.app

BUILD A BUSINESS
THAT RUNS BY ITSELF
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// THE JOURNEY

From form to finished design.

These prompts are step 5 of a 7-step journey. The first 4 steps get you a DESIGN.md to upload. The last 2 steps ship your work.

01 **Open the fillable form** — BROWSER

claude-design-beginners.vercel.app — answer 10 questions about your brand.

02 **Click Generate Claude Prompt** — BROWSER

Copy the generated prompt. Click Download brand-in-a-box.zip.

03 **Generate your brand folder** — CLAUDE CODE

Open Claude Code in the unzipped folder. Paste the prompt. ~90 seconds.

04 **Upload DESIGN.md to Claude Design** — CLAUDE DESIGN

claude.ai/design → New project → Add assets → upload DESIGN.md.

05 **Run prompts 01-05 in this handout** — CLAUDE DESIGN

Master Check first to lock the rules. Then any of 02-05 as you need.

06 **Iterate until you'd ship it** — CLAUDE DESIGN

Use prompt 05 (Iterate). Inline comments on canvas also work.

07 **Export and ship** — CLAUDE DESIGN

Claude Design exports to .zip, PDF, PPTX, HTML, Canva, or Claude Code.

PROMPT 01 / 05 // THE MASTER CHECK

Confirm. Lock. Begin.

WHEN TO RUN

First message of any Claude Design project, right after uploading DESIGN.md.

WHAT IT DOES

Confirms DESIGN.md is loaded. Locks every artifact to your voice and visual rules until you say otherwise.

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═══ DESIGN SYSTEM CHECK ═══

You should have my DESIGN.md loaded as this project's design system.

Confirm in 4 lines, no preamble:
- My accent color (hex)
- My heading font
- My body font
- My one-sentence brand description (from DESIGN.md section 9)

If any of these come back blank, generic, or wrong, the DESIGN.md is
not loaded. Tell me and stop.

═══ STANDING RULES (every artifact in this project) ═══

Voice contract:
1. Apply my voice rules from DESIGN.md section 9 to all copy.
   No em dashes, no banned phrases, no hedging language.
2. Use real example phrases from my brand description. Never lorem ipsum.
3. Before you write copy, ask: "Would the founder say this on a sales call?"
   If no, rewrite.

Visual contract:
1. Pull every color, font, spacing, and component style from DESIGN.md.
   No improvisation.
2. The accent color appears at most ONCE per visible frame, on a verb,
   a number, or a CTA. Never on body paragraphs.
3. Match the family's signature gesture (corner radius, border style,
   accent ratio).

Self-critique contract (run BEFORE rendering):
□ Scan against DESIGN.md "Don'ts." Did you do anything banned? Fix.
□ Read the copy in your head. Does it match my rhythm rules?
□ Count accent uses per frame. More than 1 visible at once? Cut.
□ Any lorem ipsum, generic stock language, or hedging? Replace.

═══ WHEN I ATTACH AN IMAGE ═══

Do not assume. Ask one question:

"Which mode?
 (a) Match-energy — borrow tone and density, not visuals
 (b) Layout-structure — borrow composition, not colors or fonts
 (c) Pure reference — extract one specific element, ignore the rest
 (d) Anti-reference — do the opposite of what this image does"
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```
Wait for my answer.

═══ DELIVERY PROTOCOL ═══

When you finish a design on canvas:
1. Render it.
2. Reply: "Done. Iterate? {one specific thing}. Next? {prompt 02-05}."

No long summaries. The canvas speaks.

═══ NOW ═══

Run the design system check above and give me the 4 lines.
```

IF THIS FAILS

If the 4 confirmation lines come back blank or generic, your DESIGN.md isn't loaded. Re-upload it under "Add assets" before continuing. None of the other prompts work without this one passing.

PROMPT 02 / 05 // TOPIC TO CAROUSEL

7 slides on canvas.

WHEN TO RUN

Anytime you need a LinkedIn carousel. Replace [INSERT TOPIC].

WHAT IT DOES

Renders 7 slides on canvas, 1080×1350 each, in your brand. Cover, 5 lessons, soft CTA. Self-checked.

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═══ MISSION ═══

Topic: [INSERT TOPIC]
Outcome: One LinkedIn carousel that earns me the inbound DM from my ICP.

═══ THINK FIRST ═══

Before generating, in your head:
1. Who specifically opens this carousel? (recall ICP from DESIGN.md)
2. What deeper pain does this carousel agitate?
3. Which hook style fits best? (refer to my voice rules)
4. ONE big idea per slide. Two ideas means two slides.

═══ STRUCTURE ═══

7 slides on canvas. 1080×1350 each. Stack vertically.

Slide 1 — COVER
  Hook in 8-12 words.
  Eyebrow pill (matches my brand's eyebrow style).
  Type-driven, big.
  Accent color on ONE word.
  Footer module if my brand uses one.

Slides 2-6 — LESSONS
  Each slide does ONE job:
    - Eyebrow "STEP N"
    - Lesson title in 5-9 words
    - Body in 2 sentences max
    - One visual element: card, icon, number, or quote
  No slide repeats the previous slide's visual move.

Slide 7 — CTA
  Soft, sounds like a DM not an ad.
  "Comment [WORD] and I'll DM you the [asset]."
  P.S. that asks a question or offers a bonus.

═══ COPY DISCIPLINE ═══

- Match my sentence rhythm within ±2 words.
- Use 1-2 of my ranked hooks.
- Include one specific number with timeframe.
- Banned phrases get auto-rejected.

Forbidden: em dashes, hashtags, emoji, "unlock," "leverage,"
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"transform," "10x," "secret"

═══ OUTPUT ═══

Render all 7 slides on the canvas as a vertical stack.
Each slide is its own frame at 1080×1350.

═══ SELF-CHECK BEFORE DELIVERY ═══

□ Banned phrases anywhere?
□ Accent color used more than once on any single slide?
□ Slide-1 hook and slide-7 CTA in same voice register?
□ Sentence rhythm matches my voice rules?
□ Slide 1 hook promises what slide 7 delivers?
□ Any AI tells — gradient, generic illustration, em dash?

═══ AFTER DELIVERY ═══

Tell me which TWO slides are weakest, offer to remix.
Suggest the next 3 carousel topics for follow-up.
```

EXPORT FROM CLAUDE DESIGN

Once you've shipped, click Export → PDF. Each slide becomes one page. That PDF goes straight to LinkedIn as a document carousel.

PROMPT 03 / 05 // WINNING AD TO MY VERSION

Reverse-engineer the win.

WHEN TO RUN

When you see an ad performing in your industry and want the same impact in your brand.

WHAT IT DOES

Forensic decode of why the ad works. Then 3 variations on canvas: faithful, confident, risky.

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═══ INPUT ═══

[ATTACH IMAGE OF THE AD]

Industry context: [my industry]
Why I think this works: [one sentence — your hypothesis]

═══ STEP 1: FORENSIC DECODE ═══

In chat (don't render anything yet), tell me:

Composition
  - Where does the eye land first, second, third?
  - Negative space ratio (% empty)?
  - What anchor holds the composition?

Copy
  - Hook structure?
  - Headline word count?
  - CTA: explicit or implicit?
  - What word does the most work?

Visual signature
  - Color hierarchy (dominant, secondary, accent — rough %)
  - Type contrast (hero/body size ratio)
  - The ONE move that makes this premium / cheap / trustworthy

Emotional beat
  - Feeling left behind?
  - Objection preempted?
  - Anti-audience?

═══ STEP 2: BRAND TRANSLATION ═══

Now render my version on canvas. Same skeleton, my brand from DESIGN.md.

Take from original:
✓ Composition (where eye lands)
✓ Copy structure
✓ Emotional beat
✓ Negative space ratio

Replace from my brand:
✗ Colors → DESIGN.md
✗ Fonts → DESIGN.md
✗ Voice → DESIGN.md voice rules
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✗ Specific imagery → my brand's imagery rules
✗ The accent move → wherever my system says

═══ STEP 3: VARIATIONS ═══

Render 3 variations side by side on canvas at the original's exact dimensions:

  V1. FAITHFUL     — closest mapping to the original
  V2. CONFIDENT    — push my brand's signature gesture harder
  V3. RISKY        — invert one decision from the original
                  (if dense → sparse). Brave version.

═══ STEP 4: VERDICT ═══

After rendering:
1. Which variation would YOU ship and why?
2. Predict A/B test ranking of original vs my V1-V3.
3. What did the original do that I should NOT copy?
```

WHERE TO FIND ADS

Screenshot from your LinkedIn feed (anything that stopped your scroll). Or saved to Pinterest. Or AdsLibrary on Facebook for paid ads. The bigger the brand you reverse-engineer, the more you learn — Stripe, Linear, Notion, Hormozi, Justin Welsh.

PROMPT 04 / 05 // PINTEREST TO MY LAYOUT

Borrow structure. Never colors.

WHEN TO RUN

When you find a beautiful layout (magazine, poster, album art) but the brand is nothing like yours.

WHAT IT DOES

Extracts compositional structure only. Renders 2 variations on canvas in your brand: faithful and loosened.

```
═══ INPUT ═══

[ATTACH PINTEREST IMAGE]
(Magazine cover, poster, album art, or editorial layout.)

What I want to build: [carousel cover / image post / one-pager / banner / pitch slide]

═══ EXTRACTION TARGETS ═══

In chat (no rendering yet), tell me:

The grid
  - Asymmetric, symmetric, or modular?
  - Where are the alignment lines?
  - Column structure?

The focal point
  - What pulls the eye first?
  - How is it framed?
  - Ratio of focal-area to total-area?

The typography hierarchy
  - Hero size : body size ratio
  - Number of distinct type styles
  - Where does type sit relative to focal point?

The density rhythm
  - Crowded → empty, or even?
  - Where does the eye rest?

═══ APPLY TO MY BRAND ═══

Render the artifact on canvas in MY brand. Structure borrowed,
everything else mine.

Forbidden imports:
✗ Colors (use DESIGN.md)
✗ Fonts (use DESIGN.md)
✗ Imagery (use my brand's imagery rules)
✗ Mood (my brand has its own)

Required from reference:
✓ The grid structure
✓ The focal-point framing
✓ The negative space ratio
```

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✓ The type hierarchy ratio

═══ OUTPUT ═══

Render two variations side by side on canvas:

  V1. FAITHFUL  — structure 1:1, brand applied
  V2. LOOSENED  — structure simplified by 20%, more breathing room

═══ AFTER ═══

In ONE paragraph (no bullets):
- What you transferred from the reference (specific layout decisions)
- What you deliberately did not transfer
- Which variation feels more like the brand and why

═══ THE TASTE TEST ═══

Before rendering, ask yourself:

"If I removed all colors and fonts, would a designer see the same
skeleton in my V1 and the reference's wireframe?"

If yes → nailed it. If no → redo.
```

REFERENCE PICKS THAT ALWAYS WORK

Editorial: Wallpaper, Kinfolk, Cereal magazine covers. Cinematic: A24 movie posters, album covers (Frank Ocean's Blonde, Tame Impala). Swiss design: vintage Müller-Brockmann posters. Pick a reference OPPOSITE to your brand for maximum effect — the contrast is the magic.

PROMPT 05 / 05 // ITERATE TO REFINE

Ship, don’t restart.

WHEN TO RUN

After any artifact, when 80% is right and 20% needs adjusting. Use the chat OR Claude Design's inline comments.

WHAT IT DOES

Renders V1 and V2 side by side on canvas. Diff explained in 60 words in chat.

```
═══ INPUT ═══

The artifact you just rendered: [name it]

═══ MY DIRECTION ═══

Want to push:
  + [thing to amplify]
  + [thing to amplify]

Want to soften:
  - [thing to dial back]
  - [thing to dial back]

Want to try:
  ? [experiment, optional]

Keep untouched: [list anything sacred]

═══ EXECUTION ═══

Step 1: Acknowledge the spec. Repeat back what you're amplifying,
softening, and trying. If anything is ambiguous, ask ONE question.

Step 2: Render V2 on canvas next to V1 (split view, same canvas size).

Step 3: In chat, give me a 60-word "diff explained" — the specific
decisions you made and why.

═══ DIFF DISCIPLINE ═══

A real iteration changes 3-5 things, not 30.

If you find yourself rebuilding half the artifact, you are starting over.
Pause and ask if that's what I want.

═══ TASTE CALIBRATION ═══

Before rendering V2:

□ Is V2 still recognisably the same artifact, just better?
□ Does it solve the spec or just change for change's sake?
□ Have I preserved every "Keep untouched" item literally?

If any answer is no, fix V2 before rendering.
```

```
═══ AFTER ═══

Two questions:
1. Ship V1, ship V2, or run another iteration?
2. If we iterate again, what's the smallest next change?
```

WHEN TO USE INLINE COMMENTS INSTEAD

For ONE small thing ("make this headline 20% bigger"), use Claude Design's inline comment on the element. For STRUCTURAL changes (composition, multiple decisions), use this prompt in chat. Inline = fast tactical edit. Chat = strategic iteration.